

ROTH, ARNOLD

FIRST APPEARANCE Captain America #270 (May 1982)

REAL NAME Arnold "Arnie" Roth

OCCUPATION Sailor, later publicist, later costume shop manager

BASE New York City

HEIGHT Unrevealed **WEIGHT** Unrevealed **EYES** Blue **HAIR** Grey

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Possessed the normal human strength of a man of his age who engaged in mild exercise.



Arnold Roth became friends with Steve Rogers when they were growing up in the 1930s. During World War II, Roth served in the US Navy and realized that CAPTAIN AMERICA was his friend Steve. While Captain America spent years in suspended animation, Roth aged normally. Learning of Roth's friendship with Captain America, Baron Helmut Zemo (see BARON ZEMO I) imperiled Roth and

his life partner, Michael. Later, the RED SKULL captured Roth. Captain America and Roth remained friends. Roth worked as the AVENGERS' publicist and managed Steve Rogers' costume shop before dying from bone cancer. **PS**

RUIZ, "RIGGER"

FIRST APPEARANCE The Mighty Thor Vol. 1 #426 (Nov. 1990)

REAL NAME Margarita Allegra "Rigger" Ruiz

OCCUPATION Police officer **BASE** New York City

HEIGHT Unknown **WEIGHT** Unknown

EYES Unknown **HAIR** Black

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Adept with range of weaponry; she invented "port-a-pulley" for easy navigation of elevator shafts.

Margarita Allegra "Rigger" Ruiz is the armory specialist of Code: Blue, a SWAT team designated to deal with superpowered criminals. Bodybuilder Rigger has come face-to-face with these superhumans on a regular basis and her experiences have been many and varied. The strongest member of Code: Blue, Rigger has rescued hostages from the Wrecking Crew, been driven mad by the Super Villain Dementia, and posed as a slave during a mission to Asgard. During this last assignment, Rigger also flirted with Fandral the Dashing, an Asgardian noble—life is never dull in Code: Blue. **AD**



RUSSIAN, THE

FIRST APPEARANCE Punisher Vol. 5 #8 (November 2000)

REAL NAME Unrevealed

OCCUPATION Mercenary **BASE** Mobile

HEIGHT 7 ft 2 in **WEIGHT** 573 lbs

EYES Blue **HAIR** Reddish-blond

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Post-reconstruction, the Russian possessed enhanced strength and damage resistance.



The mercenary nicknamed "The Russian" accepted a job from crime boss Ma Gnucci to kill the PUNISHER. After a brutal fight, the Punisher smothered the Russian, later taunting Ma Gnucci by showing her the Russian's severed head. A secret paramilitary agency

then resurrected the Russian, giving him an enhanced body with boosted olfactory senses, three hearts, and a toughened skeleton. This new body required regular injections of female hormones. The Russian apparently died when he was caught in the explosion of a nuclear warhead on Grand Nixon Island.

DW

RYKER, GENERAL J.

General John Ryker was involved in President Kennedy's assassination and dropped gamma bombs on US troops in the Gulf. Desperate to find a cure for his wife's cancer, he became obsessed with the idea that the HULK's biology held the answers. To unlock those secrets, he tormented Banner and tortured vagrants in his research facility. Realizing that success lay in the mental rather than physical manipulation of his test subjects, Ryker switched to using his soldiers. One man was changed into a corrupt version of the Hulk, codenamed FLUX. After Thunderbolt Ross informed Ryker's wife about her husband's actions, she rebuked him. Before World War Hulk (see pp. 152-5), Ryker formed the GAMMA CORPS a team of gamma-powered soldiers with grudges against the Hulk. When the Hulk returned to Earth, he set them on his old foe, but one member of the corps—Grey—later lost his temper and brought Ryker's headquarters down on top of him. **AD, MF**



A human guinea pig faces a painful death by gamma radiation.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

General John Ryker

OCCUPATION

Senior General in US Army

BASE

Currently unknown

HEIGHT 6 ft 2 in

WEIGHT 190 lbs

EYES Brown

HAIR Gray

FIRST APPEARANCE

Incredible Hulk Vol.3 #14 (May 2000)

Brilliant manipulator, possesses intuitive understanding of people's emotional vulnerabilities; exceptional strategist, excels at seeing big picture; inveterate liar; impervious to the suffering of others.

RYKER, GENERAL JOHN

POWERS